

**R22 Beta****R44****R44 Clipper II****R66**

1930 Frank Robinson is born on Whidbey Island, Washington, USA.

1957 Robinson begins his aeronautical career with Cessna as a flight engineer.

1969 Robinson moves to work for Hughes Helicopters, working on new projects.

1973 Robinson resigns from Hughes and founds his own helicopter company to design a light, affordable helicopter for the general aviation market.

1975 The first R22 takes flight at Torrance Airport, California.

1979 The R22 goes into production with a base price of \$40,000.

1981 The 100th R22 is delivered. Later that year the improved R22HP is announced.

1982 A safety course for flight instructors is launched to standardize training at flight schools.

1983 The further upgraded R22 Alpha is introduced.

1988 Robinson becomes the leading producer of light helicopters.

1990 The four-seat R44 is first flown.

1993 Delivery of the first R44 takes place.

1994 The company moves to new 260,000 square-foot (24,155 square-meter) production plant in Torrance, California.

1997 The R44 completes a round-the-world flight with pilots Jennifer Murray and Quentin Smith.

1998 The first R44 Newscopters broadcast live television from the air.

2002 The R44 Raven II is the first piston helicopter to fly to the North Pole.

2005 The 600th Robinson helicopter is delivered.

2007 Robinson announces the five-seat turbine R66.

2008 R44 production surpasses R22 in total numbers built.

2009 The 5,000th R44 is delivered.

2010 Frank Robinson announces his retirement. His son, Kurt Robinson, becomes president and chairman of the company.

2011 The 100th R66 is delivered.



Helicopter production line

Robinson helicopters are made at the company's factory in Torrance, California. Since its founding the company has produced more than 10,000 helicopters.

move up to a larger four- or five-seat helicopter. Based on the R22, the four-seat R44 introduced hydraulically assisted flight controls and a scaled-up airframe. The first R44s were delivered at the beginning of 1993. They were an instant success for the company and before long production overtook that of the R22. Improvements and special versions for police, TV broadcasting, waterborne operations, and other missions only added to the demand for both models.

Meanwhile, some Robinson fans were calling for a turbine engine to replace the traditional piston power plant. Robinson obliged by redesigning the R44 with a slightly enlarged cabin, a new Rolls-Royce turbine engine, and a separate cargo bay. It was launched in 2010 as the R66.

In 2010 Frank Robinson announced his retirement, handing the company over to his son, Kurt Robinson, and a board of directors. Production of his dream helicopters continues.

R66 in flight

The R66 went into full production in 2011 and is the largest and most powerful helicopter built by Robinson. It seats five and is the first Robinson to have space for cargo.

